

Theory of Change (ToC)

What this tool produces · *A visual impact map that chronologically connects resources (inputs), actions (activities), tangible deliverables (outputs), short-term effects (outcomes), and the ultimate societal goals (impact).*

G1 · Proof of Impact

G3 · Proof of Anchoring

Dimensions

Social / User

Economic

Spatial

Preparing the workshop · *Theory of Change (ToC)*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Working backward from a shared dream to present-day constraints, ensuring that every brick laid or policy drafted serves a profound human purpose rather than just a bureaucratic milestone.

Evidence we produce

A visual impact map that chronologically connects resources (inputs), actions (activities), tangible deliverables (outputs), short-term effects (outcomes), and the ultimate societal goals (impact).

Duration & Material

Duration · 2 days of collaborative workshops

Material · Large wall space or digital whiteboard, logic model templates, sticky notes, markers

Reference case

The URBACT U.R. Impact Network utilized the Theory of Change to shift municipalities from a fragmented project mindset to a long-term impact logic. For example, in Murcia, the ToC guided the "South Connection" project to bridge a historic railway divide, transforming 200,000 square meters into a mobility hub designed specifically to heal geographical and social inequalities.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Inputs → Activities → Outputs → Outcomes → Impact

Duration
2 days of collaborative workshops

Inputs

resources we mobilize

Activities

what we do

Outputs

what we deliver

Outcomes

what changes for users

Impact

long-term societal change

Assumptions & external factors

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.